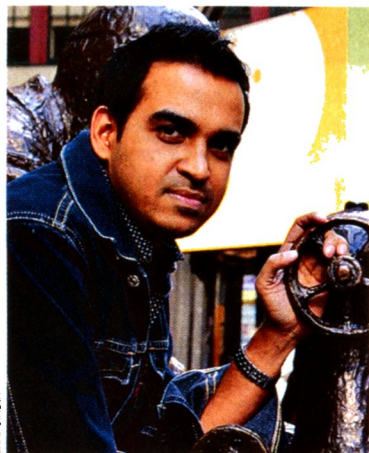




Project Runway

Manhattan's runway had an Indian twist this time. Designer Bibhu Mohapatra, who was born in Orissa, showcased his debut collection at the New York Fashion Week. No fashion rookie, Mohapatra was design director for luxury fashion house J Mendel before deciding to fly solo. Reviewing the Fashion Institute of Technology graduate's private showing, style.com said, "The designer merged his elegant evening experience with a pair of hard-edged inspirations: ancient Japanese armour and fashion warrior Daphne Guinness." Isn't that what we call a model life?

Scene Again

After playing the nubile Chanda in *Dev D*, **Kalki Koechlin** has won the MetroPlus Playwright Award 2009 for *Skeleton Lady*, a play she co-authored with actor Prashant Prakash. "After the writing, it evolved on the rehearsal floor since we're acting in it as well," says Koechlin, who plans to tour with it to Mumbai, Bangalore and Delhi.



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"He overcame one crisis after another. I want people to emulate this. He has a never-say-die approach."

Mitali Ghosal, filmmaker, on her docu-feature, *The Warrior Prince*, on the life of Sourav Ganguly

SHOW STEALER

Ditching songs for some serious stunts, British actor **Aruna Shields** is the newest entrant to Bollywood's overseas stash. The actor, who has worked in Jagmohan Mundhra's *Private Moments*, makes her Hindi film debut in the Kumar Taurani-produced, *Prince*. "We were looking for new faces. The film has a lot of action and Aruna fit the bill. She plays the role of a thief called Maya," says Taurani. The question is: will she steal the show?

